

ATPL EASA STUDY GUIDE | 090 - COMMUNICATIONS

Chapter 3: Aerodrome Control Communications

Syllabus Source: CAE Oxford (pp. 61-88) | Pass Target: >= 90% AviationExam

1. DEPARTURE INFORMATION & PUSHBACK / START-UP

Prior to requesting start-up or taxi, the flight crew must monitor ATIS and obtain local aerodrome information:

- ATIS Acknowledgment: 'INFORMATION CHARLIE RECEIVED, QNH 1014'.
- Start-up Request: Pilot: 'REQUEST START UP'. Controller: 'START UP APPROVED' or 'EXPECT START UP AT 35'.
- Pushback Request: Pilot: 'REQUEST PUSHBACK'. Controller: 'PUSHBACK APPROVED, FACING EAST'.
- Taxi Request: Pilot: 'REQUEST TAXI'. Controller: 'TAXI TO HOLDING POINT RUNWAY 27 VIA TAXIWAY ALPHA'. Readback: 'TAXI TO HOLDING POINT RUNWAY 27 VIA TAXIWAY ALPHA, IBERIA 123'.

2. HOLDING POINT PROCEDURES & RUNWAY CROSSINGS

[!] EXAM TRAP (AVIATIONEXAM) - Runway Safety & Mandatory Holding Point Readback

- A clearance to 'TAXI TO HOLDING POINT RUNWAY 27' is NOT a clearance to enter the runway! - The aircraft MUST HOLD SHORT of the yellow illuminated runway holding position markings.
- Runway Crossing: Requires explicit, distinct clearance: 'CROSS RUNWAY 09, REPORT VACATED'. The readback MUST include the runway designator: 'CROSS RUNWAY 09, WILCO, IBERIA 123'.

3. CONDITIONAL CLEARANCES (STRICT ICAO FORMAT)

Conditional clearances involve an aircraft being cleared to line up, cross, or take off subject to a preceding movement. To eliminate runway incursions, ICAO mandates a strict 3-part phrasing sequence:

Conditional Element	Operational Purpose	Exact ICAO Phraseology Example
1. The Condition	Preceding traffic identification	'IBERIA 456, BEHIND LANDING AIRBUS A320...'
2. The Clearance	Action authorized	'...LINE UP AND WAIT RUNWAY 27...'
3. Repetition of Condition	Re-affirmation of restriction	'...BEHIND.'
Mandatory Readback	Full verbatim repetition	'BEHIND LANDING AIRBUS A320, LINE UP AND WAIT RUNWAY 27 BEHIND, IBERIA 456.'

4. TAKE-OFF, ABORTED TAKE-OFF & LANDING CLEARANCES

- Line Up & Wait: 'LINE UP AND WAIT RUNWAY 27' (or 'LINE UP RUNWAY 27 AND WAIT').
- Take-off Clearance: 'CLEARED FOR TAKE-OFF RUNWAY 27, WIND 250 DEGREES 10 KNOTS'. Readback: 'CLEARED FOR TAKE-OFF RUNWAY 27, IBERIA 123'.
- Cancelling Take-off Clearance (Before Roll): Controller: 'TAKE-OFF CLEARANCE CANCELLED, HOLD POSITION'. Pilot: 'HOLDING, IBERIA 123'.

- Aborting Take-off (Emergency During Roll): Controller: 'STOP IMMEDIATELY, IBERIA 123 STOP IMMEDIATELY'. Pilot: 'STOPPING, IBERIA 123'.
- Landing Clearance: 'CLEARED TO LAND RUNWAY 27, WIND 260 DEGREES 12 KNOTS'.
- Missed Approach / Go-Around: Controller: 'GO AROUND, CLIMB TO 3000 FEET'. Pilot: 'GOING AROUND, IBERIA 123'.
- Runway Vacated: Pilot: 'RUNWAY VACATED' (transmitted only after the entire aircraft is clear of the runway holding markings).

5. VFR TRAFFIC CIRCUIT POSITION REPORTS

Circuit Position	Flight Path Geometry	Standard ICAO Radio Phraseology
Downwind	Opposite direction to landing	Transmit aircraft type, intentions (touch-and-go / full stop): 'G-ABCD, DOWNWIND RUNWAY 27, TOUCH AND GO'.
Base Leg	Turn onto base	Transmit: 'G-ABCD, BASE RUNWAY 27'.
Final	Aligned with runway (< 4 NM)	Transmit: 'G-ABCD, FINAL RUNWAY 27'.
Long Final	Aligned at greater distance	Transmit: 'G-ABCD, LONG FINAL RUNWAY 27' (between 4 and 8 NM from touchdown).

STEP-BY-STEP PROBLEM SOLVING (FOR DUMMIES / PASO A PASO)

[+] STEP-BY-STEP ALGORITHM / PASO A PASO - Algoritmo Paso a Paso (Guía para Dummies): Number Pronunciation & Reading

REGLAS MNEMOTÉCNICAS DE EXAMEN: 1. Pronunciación de números enteros: - Centenas redondas: 'HUND-red' (ej. 800 = 'AIT HUND-red'). - Millares redondos: 'TOU-SAND' (ej. 5.000 = 'FIFE TOU-SAND'). - Combinación: 38.300 = 'TREE AIT TOU-SAND TREE HUND-red'. 2. Niveles de vuelo (FL): SIEMPRE dígito a dígito (ej. FL 100 = 'FLIGHT LEVEL WUN ZE-RO ZE-RO'). 3. Escala de legibilidad: Del 1 (ininteligible) al 5 (perfecto). 'Read you 3' significa 'legible con dificultad'.

6. AVIATIONEXAM PRACTICE QUESTIONS (WITH EXPLANATIONS)

Q1: What is the correct phraseology used by a controller to instruct an aircraft to abort its take-off roll immediately?

- [A]: 'Abort take-off, cancel clearance'
- [B]: 'Stop immediately, Speedbird 123 stop immediately'
- [C]: 'Speedbird 123, hold position'
- [D]: 'Discontinue take-off now'

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Official Rationale & Exam Strategy

CORRECT: [B]. The standard emergency phraseology to abort an active take-off roll is 'STOP IMMEDIATELY' repeated twice, addressed with aircraft callsign.

Q2: In a conditional clearance, what must be transmitted first by the controller?

- [A]: The clearance to line up
- [B]: The condition (identification of preceding traffic)
- [C]: The surface wind
- [D]: The aircraft callsign followed by 'cleared'

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Official Rationale & Exam Strategy

CORRECT: [B]. Under ICAO standards, the condition must always precede the clearance (e.g. 'Behind landing B737, line up and wait behind').

Q3: When should a pilot transmit the phrase 'RUNWAY VACATED'?

- [A]: As soon as the main wheels touch down
- [B]: When the nose gear crosses the runway edge line
- [C]: Only when the entire aircraft has passed beyond the runway holding position marking
- [D]: When parked on the apron

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Official Rationale & Exam Strategy

CORRECT: [C]. 'Runway vacated' is transmitted only when all parts of the aircraft are completely past the runway holding line.

Q4: An aircraft is instructed: 'Taxi to holding point runway 09 via taxiway Bravo'. Does this authorize the aircraft to cross the runway?

- [A]: Yes, if no traffic is visible
- [B]: No, the pilot must hold short of runway 09 until receiving an explicit clearance to cross
- [C]: Yes, after transmitting 'Crossing'
- [D]: Only in daytime VMC

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Official Rationale & Exam Strategy

CORRECT: [B]. Taxi clearances to a holding point strictly terminate at the holding point. Crossing any runway requires an explicit separate clearance.

Q5: What is the correct phraseology for an aircraft commencing a missed approach on final approach?

- [A]: 'Aborting landing'
- [B]: 'Going around'
- [C]: 'Pulling up'
- [D]: 'Cancelling landing'

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Official Rationale & Exam Strategy

CORRECT: [B]. 'GOING AROUND' is the standard ICAO radiotelephony phraseology for initiating a missed approach.

Q6: At what distance from the runway threshold is an aircraft considered to be on 'Long Final'?

- [A]: Between 1 and 2 NM
- [B]: Between 4 and 8 NM
- [C]: Beyond 15 NM
- [D]: Under 1 NM

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Official Rationale & Exam Strategy

CORRECT: [B]. 'Long Final' is reported when an aircraft is turning onto final approach or tracking final at a distance greater than 4 NM (typically 4 to 8 NM).